

Durham Data Lab

Discussion Points

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20 February 2026

Purpose

- ▶ Discuss the Durham Data Lab idea with collaborators.
- ▶ Clarify priorities, constraints, and next decisions.

Team

- ▶ David Chivers (Economist, Durham University)
- ▶ Professor John Paul Gosling (Assistant Professor)
- ▶ Demic Getic (Economist, Durham University)
- ▶ Potentially one consultant (TBC)

Core Concept

- ▶ Potential spin-off delivering statistics/data courses to businesses (not students).
- ▶ Potentially also statistics/data-focused consultancy.
- ▶ Consultancy scope could span economics/management and may include individuals.

Priority 1: Durham University Involvement

- ▶ Avoid heavy bureaucracy; too much would stop the project.
- ▶ Need a conversation with relevant Durham contacts.
- ▶ Clarify what can be used and what constraints apply.

Priority 2: Business Formation & Operations

- ▶ If set up as a business, choose the right structure.
- ▶ Define practical startup steps.
- ▶ Decide how payments will be handled.
- ▶ Put clear contracts in place upfront.

Priority 3: Website

- ▶ Design and build a website.
- ▶ Treat as a subproject with its own guidelines.

Priority 4: Contracts & Tax

- ▶ Consider tax implications (likely higher-rate, 40%).
- ▶ Design payment structures to be tax-efficient.
- ▶ Treat this as a later workstream if needed.

Team & Governance Aims

- ▶ Avoid falling out; avoid avoidable issues.
- ▶ If someone is contracted to do their own work, they can be paid for that work.
- ▶ May require separate contracts within the umbrella.
- ▶ Durham Data Lab brand benefits everyone: good projects raise awareness for all.

Open Questions

- ▶ What level of Durham University involvement is required, permitted, or practical?
- ▶ Who are the right Durham contacts to clarify permissions and constraints?
- ▶ What business structure should be used?
- ▶ What is the practical launch process?
- ▶ How should payments be handled day-to-day?
- ▶ What contract types are needed at launch?
- ▶ Are separate internal contracts needed under the umbrella model?
- ▶ What payment structure is most tax-efficient given current employment and likely 40% tax status?
- ▶ Who owns and manages the website subproject, and under what guidelines?

Discussion Output (Today)

- ▶ Agree immediate next actions.
- ▶ Assign owners for the first workstreams.
- ▶ Set timeline for initial decisions.